

Power Query in My HR Analytics Dashboard (Interview Notes)

What is Power Query?

Answer: Power Query is a data cleaning and transformation tool in Power BI. Before creating charts or writing DAX, I cleaned and prepared the dataset using Power Query.

Why did I use Power Query? - I used Power Query because raw data is usually not ready for analysis.

It helped me:

- Import the dataset
- Clean the data
- Set correct data types
- Remove unnecessary columns
- Prepare the data for dashboard creation

Steps I performed in my project

1. Source

How I did it

Home → Get Data → Text/CSV → Select HRDataset_v14.csv

Why I did it - To import the HR employee dataset into Power BI.

Interview Answer - First, I imported the HR employee dataset from a CSV file using the Source step.

2. Promoted Headers

How I did it

Home → Use First Row as Header

Before

Column1
Column2
Column3

After

Employee_Name
EmplID
Salary

Why I did it - The first row contained the actual column names. Without this step, Power BI would use names like Column1 and Column2.

Interview Answer - I promoted the first row as headers so Power BI could recognize the correct column names.

3. Changed Type

How I did it - Power BI automatically detected the data types, and I verified they were correct.

Examples:

Salary → Whole Number

Employee_Name → Text

DateofHire → Date

EmpID → Whole Number

Why I did it - Power BI needs the correct data type for calculations, filtering, sorting, and charts.

Interview Answer - I assigned the correct data types to each column so calculations and visualizations would work correctly.

4. Removed Other Columns

How I did it

Select the columns I needed

Right Click

Remove Other Columns

Why I did it - The original dataset had many columns. I only kept the columns required for my dashboard. This makes the Power BI file faster and easier to manage.

Interview Answer - I removed unnecessary columns and kept only the columns required for analysis to improve performance and reduce clutter.

5. Renamed Columns

How I did it

Double-click the column name

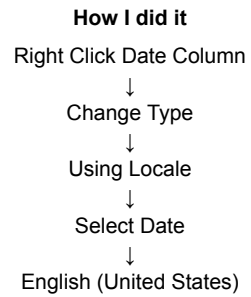
Rename it

Example
Employee Name
↓
Employee_Name

Why I did it - Short and clean column names are easier to understand and use in DAX formulas.

Interview Answer - I renamed some columns to make them more meaningful and easier to reference in DAX.

6. Changed Type with Locale



Why I did it

My dataset contained dates.

Different countries use different date formats.

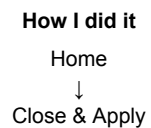
Power BI uses Locale to correctly interpret those dates.

Without Locale,

07/10/83
could be interpreted incorrectly.

Interview Answer - I used Changed Type with Locale to correctly convert date values according to the regional format used in the dataset.

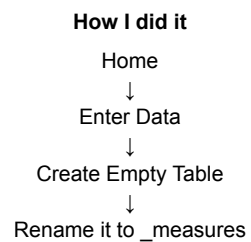
7. Close & Apply



Why I did it - This saved all my Power Query transformations and loaded the cleaned data into Power BI.

Interview Answer - Finally, I clicked Close & Apply to load the cleaned data into the Power BI model.

Measures Table (_measures)



Why I did it

I stored all DAX measures in one separate table.

This keeps the model organized.

Interview Answer - I created a separate Measures table to organize all DAX measures in one place and keep the data model clean.

Interview Question - Why didn't you clean data in Excel?

Answer: Excel cleaning is manual. Power Query automates the cleaning process. If the source data changes, I just click **Refresh**, and Power Query repeats all the same cleaning steps automatically.

Difference Between Power Query and DAX

Power Query	DAX
Cleans data	Calculates values
Used before loading data	Used after loading data
Removes unwanted columns	Creates KPIs and measures
Changes data types	Performs business calculations

30-Second Interview Answer

"In my HR Analytics Dashboard, I first imported the HR dataset using Power Query. Then I promoted the first row as headers, assigned the correct data types, removed unnecessary columns, renamed columns for better readability, and used Changed Type with Locale to correctly interpret date values. After cleaning the data, I clicked Close & Apply to load it into Power BI. I also created a separate Measures table to keep all my DAX measures organized. After that, I created relationships, wrote DAX measures, and built the interactive dashboard."